

Crash Course in Fast Food

You live dangerously if you are hungry

Ann-Kathrin Raab & Larissa Boie

October 27, 2025

Behind the Wheel, Beyond the Meal: The Motivation for Our Study

- real-life image of a situation
- google maps/OSM screenshot of typical drive through intersection
- is this just anecdotal evidence?

From Bites to Bytes: Building Our Dataset

Source for Fast-Food locations

- Open Street Map API
- 6153 locations in Ohio
- Issue: 'drive-through' tag often 'None' instead of 'yes/no'

Source for Crashes

- Public records request to Ohio Department of Public Safety
- Period: Sep 2019–Sep 2025 (5 full years)
- Total number of crashes: 1.289.913
- Main filter: explicit mention of fast-food place in the crash report narrative (32.760)

Fast-food location filtering and things to compare

Our subsets to compare and the reasoning behind it:

- Top 20 non-pizza fast food chains
 - In queue, food is handed through window
 - Stressful situation to handle food and driving away at the same time, very distracted
- Top X pizza chains
 - Food is brought to the curb
 - No pressure of having to make space for someone immediately, more relaxed
 - Less distraction
- Top Y coffee chains
 - Does the need for caffeine play a role?
- Top Z gas stations
 - similar road situation, but less distracted due to food

Beyond the Drive-Thru: What the Data Really Says

- Causality vs Correlation
- Graph of Crashes over hour of the day, peak at lunch for fast-food crashes

Trends Over Time

Trend plot goes here

Key Takeaways

- Placeholder conclusion 1
- Placeholder conclusion 2
- Placeholder conclusion 3

Thank You!

Questions?